

Manik Madaan

Product Design Leader / Manager

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SUMMARY

Product design leader with more than a decade across freelance practice, studios, agencies, startups and education technology, in India and Italy. At Novatr I built and led the product design team, shaped the learning platform behind a 4x rise in revenue, and designed the growth, sales and operations tools around it. I am most useful where a problem is complicated and the system is hard to see: finding the problem beneath the request, and making it clear enough for a team to act.

EXPERIENCE

Product Design Manager, Novatr (formerly OneistoX)

Oct 2022 – Sep 2024 | Gurugram, Haryana, India

- Led the design of a Learning Management System that helped grow company revenue 4x and set up a projected 5x ARR growth.
- Drove growth: a referral engine that brought in 25% of revenue, and Career Navigator, a PLG tool that grew organic traffic, MQLs and SQLs.
- Created a unified family of design systems across websites, web apps, mobile and internal tools.
- Designed a placement portal for graduates, and internal tools (CMS, sales dashboard, Order Management System) on HubSpot CRM.
- Built the design team, led the rebrand from OneistoX to Novatr, and set up how design worked with product, engineering and QA.

Product Design Lead, Shyft (formerly Mindhouse)

Nov 2021 – Oct 2022 | Gurugram, Haryana, India

- Carried the product through the move from Mindhouse to Shyft, and established its design language and system for scale.
- Led new experiences across yoga, mental health, sleep and nutrition programmes, onboarding and profiles, on mobile and web.

Senior Product Designer, Hapramp Studio (GoSocial)

Jul 2020 – Nov 2021 | Gurugram, Haryana, India

- Built and led the product design team from the ground up: hiring, skill development and a collaborative design culture.
- Led the design of GoSocial, tools for creators to build, engage and earn from their communities.

Product Design Consultant, Apostify

Dec 2019 – Jul 2020 | Delhi NCR, India

- Shaped the early product of a writing and publishing community.
- Three months in, recognised the work had drifted from the problem and led the pivot, rather than protect the time and money spent.

Interaction Designer, Leo Burnett (Arc Worldwide)

Nov 2016 – Dec 2017 | Turin, Piedmont, Italy

- Designed digital products and interactive campaigns for FCA Bank, Comau and Fiat.
- Shaped user journeys and experience strategy across brand, product and campaign.

Communications and Operations, Manik Automec

Jan 2018 – Dec 2019 | Faridabad, Haryana, India

- Ran communication and operations for the family auto-components business.

Founder and Principal Designer, Arcept Design

Dec 2013 – Dec 2015 | New Delhi, India

- Ran an independent studio through college, owning clients and delivery.

User Experience Designer, Weird Logics

Jun 2012 – Aug 2013 | Gurugram, Haryana, India

- Early iPad and digital products, when product design in India meant physical things.

Design Intern, Creative Gaga

Jun 2011 – Jul 2011 | New Delhi, India

- A first professional role, in the design team of an art and design magazine.

EDUCATION**MA, Interaction Design, Domus Academy (NABA)**

2016 – 2017 | Milan, Italy | Master's degree

BA (Hons), Communication Design, Pearl Academy

2011 – 2015 | New Delhi, India | Merit scholarship

Micro cinema, Santa Fe University of Art and Design

2013 | Santa Fe, New Mexico, USA | Short course

B.Tech, Mechanical Engineering, The NorthCap University (formerly ITM University)

2009 – 2011 | Gurugram, India | Dropped out

SKILLS

Leadership: Building and leading design teams, Hiring and mentoring, Design culture and critique, Stakeholder alignment

Product: Product strategy, Discovery and user research, Product-led growth, Data-informed decisions

Craft: Interaction design, Design systems, Prototyping, Visual and motion design

Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud, After Effects, AI-assisted prototyping